Contact

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Michael A. Brown

Partner at Shield Capital; Former Director, Defense Innovation Unit (DIU), U.S. Dept of Defense; Advisory Board, Center for a New American Security; Senior Defense Panel Advisor to the Special Competitive Studies Project
Palo Alto, California, United States

Summary

The Defense Innovation Unit (DIU) accelerates the adoption of leading commercial technology into the military. We're working to implement commercial solutions that can transform how the Defense Department operates or its capabilities such as using artificial intelligence for predictive maintenance to improve the uptime and cost of maintenance for military aircraft.

As a White House Presidential Innovation Fellow, I worked at DIUx (Defense Innovation Unit Experimental, www.diux.mil) as the co-author of a report on the level of foreign investment in early stage technology ventures. Additionally, I supported passage of the Foreign Investment Risk Review Modernization Act (FIRRMA) and led an initiative for a Defense Department investment vehicle for dual-use hardware technologies called National Security Innovation Capital. Both were signed into law in August, 2018.

As President and CEO of Symantec, the world's leading cybersecurity firm, we refocused the company on its core business of security (and in the process sold Veritas and returned the proceeds to shareholders). We developed and articulated a new unified security strategy leveraging Symantec's key strength of understanding more about the global threat environment than any other company in the world. I recruited a new executive team and continued to change our business model to include more subscription services (security-as-a-service) deployed from the cloud. I joined Symantec's Board of Directors following the company's merger with Veritas Software in July 2005, and previously served as Chairman and CEO of Quantum Corporation.

In addition, I serve on the Board of Trustees for the Berklee College of Music (Boston) and in my spare time I play keyboards with the

Wildcats, a classic rock dance band which has raised over $150,000 for local public schools.

Experience

Shield Capital
Partner
October 2022 - Present (3 years 10 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Center for Security and Emerging Technology (CSET)
Member of the Board of Advisors
September 2025 - Present (11 months)
Washington, DC

Advise the Director on expanding the role and relevance of the research of CSET

Special Competitive Studies Project - SCSP
Advisor
March 2025 - Present (1 year 5 months)

Institute for Security and Technology (IST)
Distinguished Senior Fellow
October 2024 - Present (1 year 10 months)

Center for a New American Security (CNAS)
Board of Advisors
October 2022 - Present (3 years 10 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Council on Global Competition and Innovation - CGCI
Council Member
April 2025 - Present (1 year 4 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Strider Technologies
Board Member
December 2022 - Present (3 years 8 months)
Salt Lake County, Utah, United States

Information Technology and Innovation Foundation
Board Member
December 2022 - Present (3 years 8 months)

ASIMILY
Board Member and Investor
August 2017 - Present (9 years)
Sunnyvale, California

Comprehensive medical device automation and management powered by AI

Revic AI
Investor and Advisor
January 2022 - Present (4 years 7 months)

The Hoover Institution, Stanford University
Visiting Scholar
September 2022 - August 2024 (2 years)
Stanford, California

Defense Innovation Unit (DIU)
Director
September 2018 - September 2022 (4 years 1 month)
Mountain View, CA

Accelerating adoption of advanced commercial technology to the military

Berklee College of Music
Board of Trustees
October 2013 - June 2021 (7 years 9 months)
Boston, MA

The Berklee College of Music Board of Trustees are the primary fiduciaries of the college and are familiar with Berklee’s mission, objectives, policies, and programs. Trustees have a strong interest in the future of the college and are ambassadors of the college.

White House Presidential Innovation Fellows
Presidential Innovation Fellow
November 2016 - September 2018 (1 year 11 months)
San Francisco Bay Area & Washington, D.C.

Working with Defense Innovation Unit Experimental (DIUx) at the Defense Department

Symantec

13 years 6 months

CEO

March 2014 - August 2016 (2 years 6 months)

Mountain View, California

As President and CEO of Symantec, the world’s leading cybersecurity firm, we refocused our business on security (selling the Veritas software business), articulated a new company strategy to leverage our strengths in security, recruited a new executive team, continued to change our business model towards security-as-a-service and improved profitability.

Board Member

March 2003 - August 2016 (13 years 6 months)

Mountain View, CA

I joined Symantec's Board of Directors following the company's merger with Veritas Software in July 2005.

Echo Nest, now part of Spotify

Board Member

July 2011 - February 2014 (2 years 8 months)

Somerville, MA

In 2011, I invested in and joined the board of the Echo Nest, a music intelligence platform with the world’s largest repository of data about music powering some of the world’s most widely used music services: Spotify, Sirius XM, Clear Channel and Vevo. In March 2014, Spotify purchased Echo Nest.

Line 6, now part of Yamaha

Chairman of the Board

September 2004 - January 2014 (9 years 5 months)

Calabasas, CA

Line 6 is a supplier of modeling guitars, guitar amplifiers and other audio gear incorporating digital signal processing. During my tenure, revenues more than doubled to reach $100 million per year and was among the top 50 music and audio companies worldwide when Yamaha purchased the company in 2014.

Quantum Corporation

11 years 7 months

CEO & Chairman of the Board

September 1995 - July 2003 (7 years 11 months)

San Jose, CA

Achieved record revenues of $6 billion as the world’s leader in disk drives for personal computers and the world’s largest tap drive business. During my tenure, Fortune magazine recognized Quantum as one of the 100 Best Places to Work.

President, Desktop and Portable Storage Group
1993 - September 1995 (2 years)
San Jose, CA

Led the company’s diversification into new storage systems businesses and grew systems revenues ten-fold.

EVP & Chief Operating Officer
January 1992 - 1993 (1 year)
San Jose, CA

Under my leadership, Quantum grew from $3 billion to $6 billion in revenues and held market leadership positions in primary storage, secondary storage as well as back-up and archiving solutions.

Education

Stanford University Graduate School of Business
MBA · (1982 - 1984)

Harvard University
Bachelor's Degree, Economics · (1976 - 1980)